

Monthly Protection Overview – June 2024 – Ethiopia

Part 1

Attacks on civilians <i>(including humanitarian workers and civilian infrastructures/facilities)</i>	Gambella	1 individual was killed and 5 were injured in Gambella town between 22 -24 June 2024. The incident is reportedly related to the on-going tribal conflict. - A motorbike was reportedly attacked by UAG on 22 June 2024 in Dimma woreda and resulted in the death of two individuals while the bike rider sustained injury.
	Oromia	West Oromia: In the month of June, the security situation has deteriorated with active conflict between government security forces and UAGs in East Wollega and Horo Guduru Wollega zone.
	Somali	Tribal conflict that resulted casualties due to land dispute is reported in Doolo zone. However, there is no displacement reported so far. - The Siti zone situations remain unpredictable with ongoing fighting. Nevertheless, due to lack of access to the affected areas and proper information, the forcibly displaced persons remain scattered into several locations without adequate response and support. The fighting is reported to continue involving regional forces from both sides.
New displacements <i>(specify the reason for displacement)</i>	Oromia	West Oromia: In Abe Dongoro woreda of Horo Guduru Wollega zone, due to conflict between security forces and UAGs, 3,928HHs/ 8,436 individuals were displaced.
	Somali	See part on floods.
	Tigray	New arrivals to the Northwestern Zone from Western, Mai Tsebri, and a high flow of refugee returnees from Sudan.
Returns, relocations and durable solutions	Oromia	West Oromia: In the three phases of the government-led exercise coupled with a spontaneous movement, a total of 2,813 Ind (716HHs) were returned/relocated from Amhara region to the Oromia region of East and West Wollega as well as West Showa zones.
	Somali	Upcoming relocation plan to Bayahow, where more than 650 IDPs from Qoloji will be relocated on 15 July, is announced by the regional DRMB. Protection Cluster and HLP working group are preparing to actively participate and follow-up in the relocation process.
	Tigray	- On 29 June, following an Ad Hoc meeting, nearly 900 IDPs from Shire and Endabaguna returned to four kebeles of Tselemti wereda (Maiayni, Maianbesa, Wehedet, and Medhenalem). Approximately 50% of the returnees are female. As of 1 July 2024, the interim government of Tigray plans to return nearly 2,000 IDPs to seven kebeles of Laelay Tselemti and Tahitay Tselemti Woreda. - Refugee returnees and new arrivals are at heightened risk due to lack of access to basic services and need immediate attention and intervention. Limited partners' response to the current return plan from the government.

	Oromia	• East/West Hararghe: In East and West Hararghe dramatic increase has been reported in the price of food items. • West Oromia: As of 16 June, Ethiopian Airlines has started three flights per week from Addis Ababa to Nekemte.
	Somali	• Situation remain similar as last month. Food is the most pressing need for the IDP populations, who suffer immensely to meet their basic needs. No humanitarian assistance for the IDP in Siti and the protracted drought-related IDPs. • Food insecurity, high prices inflation, and insufficient food assistance remain critical challenges resulting in the increase of family separation, migration, school dropout, children begging, child labour to contribute to household income generation, which includes young/adolescent girls moving to urban areas to work. • The IDP populations are not provided with adequate health services in any of the places that have been visited.
	Tigray	• Outbreak of zoonotic diseases, particularly rabies, poses a significant threat to both animals and humans, further exacerbated by the absence of effective control measures. • IDPs held peaceful demonstrations in different cities of Tigray on 23 June, demanding full implementation of the Pretoria agreement and return of IDP to their place of origin. • Starting from 22 June, demonstrations were conducted for three consecutive days in all zonal and woreda towns of Tigray, organized by Tigray's Women's Association to oppose women's and girls' rights violations in Tigray, demanding an end to violence against women in the region and justice for victims of sexual violence, kidnappings, and other abuses. According to the Mekelle City Police Office, 12 murders of women crimes were committed in the last 11 months. • Local sources reported that on 20 June, ENDF allowed Tigray forces to control Raya Alamata kebeles (Kubikerensa Chelekot and Babokurman) including Waja, and to patrol the main road. IDPs in Alamata have permission to hold public gatherings and discuss with the community. The interim administration has also started holding public forums in schools in the city. A 3G internet service has been launched in the city and surrounding areas.
Drought/flood highlights <i>(if applicable)</i>	Oromia	• East/West Hararghe: According to the DRMO in East Hararghe zone, 40,665 individuals have migrated as result of the drought induced food insecurity. In East Hararghe, 1,216 out of 1,734 water ponds have dried up.
	Somali	• A total of 17,925 households, comprising approximately 25,445 individuals, were impacted by floods from the Weyb, Genalle, and Shabelle rivers, as well as runoff floods. Specifically, 5,850 households in Cherrati, 5,229 households in Dollobay, 5,246 households in Hargelle, and 1,600 households in West Emay were affected.
	Tigray	• The existing drought has still worsened protection concerns. Moreover, the absence of food supplies has compelled certain individuals to beg for sustenance.

Access to fundamental rights and basic services

Item	Please use the drop-down menu	Please briefly explain
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Did the access situation by protection actors to affected population improved, remained similar or deteriorated? (compared with the last reporting period)	Access situation improved	Somali: No difficulties/obstacles reported. However, low protection services in many zones and the rise critical needs for support on food, health, NFIs, livelihood opportunities. Tigray: IDP return exercise officially conducted by the regional government to four kebeles of Tselemti wereda (Maiayni, Maianbesa, Wehedet, and Medhenalem). The contested areas in the southern zone are accessible.
	Access situation remained similar	East/West Hararghe
	Access situation deteriorated	Gambella: Field missions have temporarily been suspended as the tension was reported due to the tribal conflict. Wollega zones: The security situation in Wollega zones has deteriorated due to the eruption of armed conflict between government forces and UAGs.
Please list and explain the most critical barriers for protection actors to access to affected population	On-going insecurity or hostilities affecting humanitarian assistance (incl. presence of ERWs)	Gambella: Recurrent tribal conflict is the most critical barriers for protection actors to access affected populations. Wollega zones: The ongoing armed conflict has had a negative impact on accessing IDP kebeles in the Wollega zone.
	Environmental and logistical constraints	Somali: Populations in hard-to-reach areas have not been supported
	Other, please specify	East/West Hararghe: Lack of Protection partners. the number of partners is reducing, and the partners are also reducing area of coverage. Tigray: Shelter in most IDP sites is damaged, reconstruction is urgently needed. Refugee returnees and new arrivals are at heightened risk due to lack of access to basic services and need immediate attention and intervention. Unbalance of resources between humanitarian actors and the existing demand of IDPs. Limited funding for program operations. Project phase-out of partners affects our referral linkages. 3 Partners closed projects in some locations (Alight, Plan Int, HIS). Limited opportunities to earn a sustainable livelihood and economic empowerment.
Did the access situation for affected populations to protection services improved, remained similar, or deteriorated? (compared with the last reporting period)	Access situation improved	
	Access situation remained similar	East/West Hararghe Somali: In Siti, access to affected population in the affected areas remain critical. Wollega zones: Insecurity impedes movement, and humanitarian actors decrease from time to time due to a lack of funding. There is still a significant gap between the need and the actual response.

	Access situation deteriorated	Gambella: Tribal conflict-related security incidents are hindering the affected populations to access appropriate protection services.
Please list and explain the most critical barriers for affected populations to access protection services:	Ongoing insecurity or hostilities	Gambella: The recurrent tribal conflict is the most critical barrier for affected populations to access protection services. Wollega zones: Limited funding
	Unavailability of protection services	East/West Hararghe Somali: Zones such as Erer, Nogob, Doolo, Korahey and Jarar remain with zero/limited protection partners.
With whom has the Protection Cluster/AoR consistently engaged on access for protection (during this reporting period)?	OCHA	Tigray: The forum is functional under OCHA leadership where all humanitarian partners are engaged in information exchanges and production of access mapping and issues related to negotiation.
	National or local authorities	Gambella: Gambella Sub-National protection cluster is liaising with Bureau of women and social affairs (BoWSA) and disaster risk management service (DRMS) for protection. Wollega zones: Busa Gonofa, Zonal Women's and Children Affairs office
	International NGOs	East/West Hararghe
	Others (please specify)	Somali: Regional authorities, UN, INGOs/LNGOs, coordination, WGs.

Service/need	Region/woreda(s)	Population affected	Relevant changes during the month in the access to fundamental right / basic service and impact on the affected population
Access to Justice (incl. HLP dispute resolutions)	Somali		Major issues: - In relocation sites such as Awbare and Goljano, IDPs are facing challenges in accessing land for farming and grazing, as well as lacking proper housing entitlements. This persistent issue is significantly impacting the lives of the IDPs. - Specific cases of HLP concerns have been reported in Dhurwale and Goljano. However, the DRMB (Disaster Risk Management Bureau) and IOM have emphasized that there is a major HLP concern in Awbare, where IDPs have been relocated. In response, the working group has agreed to advocate for improved access to HLP in this area.
Child Protection services	Oromia / East and West Hararghe zones	All	In West Hararghe zone, children abandoned by parents are a huge concern in Chiro and crimes against women and children not being taken seriously and early marriage in the community are concerning, especially with children raising children.

Child Protection services	Tigray	IDPs and host communities	• Critical capacity gaps in case management at Woreda levels to manage cases. • The UNICEF Team conducted visits to Zata, Ofra, Raya Chercher, Korem town, Alamata town, and parts of Raya Alamata. High protection concerns and other proxy indicators were noted.
Food and nutrition	Oromia / East Hararghe zone	IDPs in sites	• The number of malnutrition cases is increasing drastically. IDPs as well as host community are facing scarcity of food. It has been several months since most of the IDPs received food assistance. For instance, in Kersa woreda it has been seven months since the IDPs received food. In Deder woreda the IDPs have not received food for one year and a half.
Food and nutrition	Oromia / Wollega zones	IDPs and Returnees	• Pregnant and lactating women, children, elderly without support, and PWD. IDPs are engaging in negative coping mechanisms.
Food and nutrition	Somali		• In Siti, shelter and NFI are desperately needed - People are living on tiny rocks covered in pieces of plastic and without erecting improvised homes out of sticks coated in plastic, so shelter is desperately needed-this situation remain unchanged so far. Only little government response has reached the community.
Food and nutrition	Tigray	IDPs and host communities/ the whole community	• Based on the Tigray area mehere assessment results, the number of needy people in the region is 4.5 million and the allocated resource by non-governmental partners for the month of June is only for 2,099,513 People (46%) • Negative coping mechanisms have continued because of a lack of access to basic needs. • Limited access and availability of agricultural inputs (esp. seeds including forage seeds) in the region.
GBV core services	Oromia / East and West Hararghe zones	All	• According to data obtained from East Hararghe Zonal Women and Children's Affairs, between September 2023 and June 2024: 236,332 women and 276,305 children are facing food insecurity and malnutrition; 3,052 children (M 1,557, F 1,495) have sustained different types bodily injuries, early marriage (166), abduction (20), FGM (17), rape (M 1, F 110), child labor (M 519, F 87, total 1006), other forms of GBV (575), migration (M 466, F 376, total 852) and children living on the street (M 474, F 12, total 486) • According to data obtained from West Hararghe Zonal Women and Children's Affairs, between September 2023 and June 2024: abduction 10, physical violence 4, rape 39, attempted rape 19, FGM 9, bigamy 77, serious bodily injury 23, simple bodily injury 153, attempted murder 8, killing spouse 14, early marriage 27, abandoning a new born 48, killing and abandoning new born 3, and human trafficking 12.
GBV core services	Tigray	IDPs and host communities	• Women and girls in the region persist in enduring GBV as a result of various factors, primarily being impacted by the crisis, harmful social norms, and natural disasters.

IGA/livelihood for GBV survivors/people at risks of GBV			- To have a consolidated response for vulnerable women and girls during the return exercise, a spreadsheet is distributed among partners to gather contributions from each of the organizations working on GBV programming. - In the NorthWest zone of the region, heavy rainfall and storms emerge as a significant risk factor for GBV, resulting in numerous women, girls, and children being greatly impacted by the circumstances. - Following the crisis in the region, new methods of committing GBV have emerged, such as abduction, rape and homicide. Minimal access to dignity kits and sanitary pads.
Health services	Oromia / East and West Hararghe zones	All	Expiry of community-based health insurance for IDPs to get free health care as vulnerable part of the community. Cholera is a big concern, with a total of 2,166 cases and 8 deaths reported in 21 woredas in East Hararghe zone and 476 cases and 8 deaths in 9 woredas in West Hararghe zone. The cholera is active in 6 woredas in West Hararghe and 11 woredas in East Hararghe.
Health services	Tigray	IDPs and host communities	Suspected Measles outbreak reported from Bonake Kebelle, Tsmbla Woreda - 13 cases and 2 deaths (19 and 2 y.o.). Suspected Malaria outbreak reported from Abiadi Town (via community). Outbreak of zoonotic diseases (Anthrax and Rabies) in various woredas Tigray. - Four people in Hintalo, South West Tigray, have died after consuming contaminated beef from an anthrax-infected ox, according to the Tigray Health Bureau. Eight others remain hospitalized. Limited supply of animal vaccines and treatment drugs.
Land marking and clearance form ERWs	Tigray	IDPs and host communities	- UXOs/ERW contamination in most parts of the region causing deaths and injuries and limited services - On 8 June, an EO incident occurred in Hawzen Woreda, Maygabo kebele killing 3 children and wounding 1. The incident reportedly happened while kids were playing with ammunition fuse. More than 400 explosive ordnances have been moved and handed over to police stations to save lives and reduce the risk of incidents involving the communities. DRC, DCA, HI, and BBC Media Action got accreditation from the federal government to work on mine clearance.
Livelihood opportunities (incl. cash)	Somali		Overall, food security and the repetitive emergencies, lack of community-led initiative programs and livelihood support have weakened the community resilience and increased their vulnerabilities, further exposing them to different risks and the practice of negative coping mechanisms such as begging, theft, family separation and exploitation.
MHPSS	Oromia / Wollega zones	IDPs and Returnees	GBV survivors, women, and people with disabilities. The majority of IDPs experience distress and trauma as a result of witnessing or being

			victims/survivors of conflict-related violence, as well as the loss of family and loved ones.
Shelter/NFI	Tigray	IDPs and host communities	• Severe Weather Events: Windstorms, rainstorms, hailstorms, and heavy rainfall have damaged shelters, many of which are makeshift and prone to collapse. • Lack of Immediate Support: partners are unable to provide immediate aid due to insufficient resources. • Damage to Shelters in Asgede: Over 750 household shelters in Hitsats were damaged by severe weather on June 8-9, 2024. • High Vulnerability in Tahtay Adiyabo: A heavy rainstorm on June 7, 2024, affected over 450 household shelters in informal settlements, with IDPs needing immediate ES kits. • Urgent Shelter Maintenance Needed in Shire Town: IDP sites, including 5 Angels camps, lack maintenance, leaving around 1,500 households exposed to harsh weather. Immediate support for shelter maintenance and ES kits is needed.
Shelter/NFI	Oromia / Wollega zones	IDPs and Returnees	• Due to the destruction of shelters coupled with the lack of NFIs, IDPs were not able to return to their place of origin.
WASH	Oromia / East and West Hararghe zones	All	• Limited WASH partners, shortage of cholera medications and water treatment chemicals and limited access to clean water are contributing to the spread of cholera. Risk of cholera spreading to IDP camps. The water sources are contaminated: Water quality test in West Hararghe revealed an average of 76% contamination.

Part 2

AoR/WG	Child Protection (CP)
Main Achievements	• CP AoR meetings and coordination continued on national level, 8 regions and 14 zones • Under the coordination of the CP and GBV AoR in Amhara, a Case Management task force composed of case management service providers is to be established to offer strategic direction, leadership, and technical support to ensure ethical and high-quality case management care and support. Similar task force/technical working group was established in Tigray around two years ago. The primary objectives of the task force are to: 1. enhance and standardize the quality and delivery of case management services in humanitarian responses; 2. facilitate information sharing on case management, serve as a forum for learning, and promote the harmonization of standards and practices; 3. contextualizing tools relevant to case management administration and service provision. • In Amhara, efforts have been focused on strengthening child protection case management, which will be further intensified with the re-deployment of 135 social service workforce Child Protection Case Workers (CSWs) and the existing 45 (39-M, 6-F) Mental Health and Psychosocial Support (MHPSS) professionals stationed across different crisis-affected zones. Building the capacity of child protection actors and frontline workers remains a crucial strategy for providing comprehensive child protection services.

Main Challenges and Gaps	
Underserved locations	• The situation in the Busa IDP sites is particularly concerning, with rampant family separation and GBV. • During a recent mission to Salahad and Legahida woredas in the Erer zone, the findings indicated that the limited presence of humanitarian aid and government attention had worsened the challenges faced by IDPs. Physical access constraints have worsened conditions in the four woredas of Qubi, Mayomulko, Salahad, and Legahida. Reports also indicate significant labor migration towards Somaliland, Kismayo, and Bosaso, leading to the separation of families and leaving women, girls, and children behind in IDP camps. • Recent heavy rains in the Shabelle zone and the Bali highlands of the Oromia region have led to flash floods and overflowing riverbanks. According to the Shabelle flood rapid assessment report, 7,459 households (48,483 individuals) were displaced in the woredas of Kelefo, Mustahil, Ferfer, and Ber-ano. The displaced individuals are living in dire conditions, often sheltering in small, cramped, locally built dwellings with insufficient cover, forcing many to live exposed to the elements. • 470 HHs of new arrivals from Mai-Tsebri were registered, with 2,400 IDPs including 120 UASC, that are in critical need of humanitarian services.
Main findings (from assessment, protection monitoring, surveys conducted during the reporting period)	The CP AoR in Tigray participated in a joint monitoring missions in Southern zone assessed humanitarian needs in Maichew and Mokoni Woredas, piloted a situation monitoring tool with other partners. The Southern Zone has a total population of 814K people. There are about 60k IDPs in Southern zone while 59k IDPs are reported to have returned to their places of origin. The current IDP population in the Zone stands at 54k people (26k are children). According to the zonal authority a total of 2,494 HHs (5,104 individuals) are currently residing in five schools in Mekoni and Maichew and in south-eastern in one municipality office. The schools are overcrowded and the limited technical and social infrastructure in the schools is serving both the IDPs and the students (Meher Assessment Nov 2023). Most of the IDPs were displaced from contested areas including Alamata, Korem, Raya Chercher, Ofla, Raya Alamata, and Zata. The above areas were reportedly inaccessible in April however, a recent UNICEF mission that preceded Security and Access mission, reported that 5 out of 6 Woredas are now accessible for programme operations. Main Child Protection Issues and needs: 1. 167 Unaccompanied and separated children need immediate support for FTR. 2. Majority of displaced children from contested areas have been involved in child labour to meet their needs and needs of their families. This has subjected them to further abuse, violence, and exploitation. Some of the children work in farms, hotels, building construction, begging, porters and increased number of children in street situations etc. 3. Partners reported cases of sexual assault against girls and women, transactional sex and lack of access to health services and specialized MHPSS. 4. IDP leaders and community leaders alluded to the large numbers of children that were given away in marriage during and after the war due to harsh economic conditions and as a measure to protect girls from sexual violence by armed actors. This harmful practice was further compounded by closure of schools for three years, due to the conflict that created despondency about their future. 5. Local authorities and community members expressed concerns about the levels of contamination of their land and properties with UXOs and ERW because of the conflict. About 120 people including 73 children (57 deaths and 63 injuries) have been allegedly victims of ERWs/UXOs. 6. 3,667 children in Alamata, Raya Alamata, Zata, Korem, Ofla and Chercher live in child headed households, have chronic illness that require medical support while others have disabilities.

	7. Most children expressed fear for their security and safety in an event of return to their places of origin. They have heard horrific stories of killings and torture committed against their families back in Alamata, Chercher, Korem and Afla, in addition to witnessing most of the crime scenes during the war prior to their displacement to Maichew and Mekoni. This has exacerbated levels of MHPD among children. 8. Local leaders agreed that there are a number of young people that were demobilized from the armed groups. 9. Reports indicate that some spontaneous IDP returnees became victims of torture and other human rights violations by armed actors in Alamata, Korem and Ofla. Whilst some managed to escape back to Maichew and Mekoni, a number of them were reportedly killed or detained. People's property was reportedly looted and burnt during the conflict and women and girls subjected to GBV.
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Part 3

Coordination mechanisms and outcomes for the reporting period

Cluster/AoR presence/functioning	• East/West Hararghe: East Hararghe Protection Cluster meeting June 10; West Hararghe Protection Cluster meeting June 19	
Protection Assessments	• Somali: Rapid Flood Impact Assessment Report	
Protection monitoring		
Relevant documents	• Gambella: Gambella region disaster risk management service (DRMS) has disseminated 2024 flood contingency plan and 2024 emergency preparedness and response plan (EPRP) – Gambella Sub-National protection cluster is part of it	
Working Groups, Task Forces, collaborations	• East/West Hararghe: Oromia regional ICCG meeting • Gambella: Gambella Sub-National protection cluster attends Gambella region disaster risk management technical working group (DRMTWG) • Tigray: Emergency Coordination Center (ECC Tigray Region); Inter-Cluster Coordination Group; Bi-weekly PC Coordination Meeting; Child Protection AoR; Mine Action AoRs; GBV AoR; Housing, Land and Property Technical WG (HLP-TWG); Disability/Inclusion Technical working group.	